# Mikayel Tovmasyan

Public Economics Chair
WFI – Ingolstadt School of Management
Catholic University of Eichstätt-Ingolstadt, Germany

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## Research and Teaching Fields

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| Research | Public Economics; International Economics; Political Economics; Applied Microeconomics |
| Teaching | Microeconomics and Macroeconomics; Public Economics; Causal Inference and Policy Evaluation; Econometrics; Mathematics and Statistics for Social Scientists and Economists |

Job-market paper: *Bypassing Sanctions: Hide 'N Seek in Tax Havens*
Revise and resubmit, *Journal of International Economics*.

## Education

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|---|---|
| 04/2022–present | **Doctoral candidate in Economics**<br>Catholic University of Eichstätt-Ingolstadt (KU), Germany<br>Expected completion: June 2027<br>Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Dominika Langenmayr |
| 2018–2021 | **M.Sc. Economics, research track**<br>University of Bayreuth, Germany<br>Thesis: *Climate-related natural disasters, economic growth and civil conflict: A causal machine learning approach*<br>Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Mario Larch; degree grade: 1.6 (1 best; 5 worst) |
| 2009–2010 | **M.Sc. Economics**<br>London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), UK<br>Thesis: *Convergence across the U.S. States*<br>Supervisor: Timothy Besley; grade: Merit |
| 1997–2001 | **B.Sc. Economics**, Highest Honors (Red Diploma)<br>Yerevan State University, Armenia |

## Academic Appointments and Research Visits

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|---|---|
| 04/2022–present | **Research Associate**<br>Public Economics Chair, WFI – Ingolstadt School of Management, Catholic University of Eichstätt-Ingolstadt<br>Fixed-term appointment through March 2027 |
| 01/2026–04/2026 | **Visiting Researcher**<br>International Tax Observatory, Paris School of Economics, France<br>Invited by Gabriel Zucman |
| 09/2023–02/2024 | **Lecturer in Economics** (in German)<br>Technische Hochschule Ingolstadt (THI) |
| 04/2019–07/2019 | **Teaching Associate in Econometrics** (in German)<br>Chair of Empirical Economics, University of Bayreuth, Germany<br>Undergraduate econometrics tutorials |
| 2014–2018 | **Full-time Lecturer in Economics**<br>College of Business & Economics, American University of Armenia (AUA, affiliated with UC Berkeley)<br>Economics teaching for undergraduate and graduate business and economics programs (in English) |
| 12/2012–06/2014 | **Adjunct Lecturer in Business Mathematics**<br>International Center for Agribusiness Research and Education (ICARE, affiliated with Texas A&M University), Yerevan, Armenia<br>Master of Agribusiness program (in English) |

# Teaching Experience

**Undergraduate courses**

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| | *Independent teaching* |
| Lectures & tutorials | Political Economy, KU; Winter 2022/23, 2023/24, 2024/25, 2026/27 (in English) |
| Lectures & tutorials | Grundlagen der Mikro- und Makroökonomie (Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics), THI; Winter 2023/24 (in German) |
| Lectures & tutorials | Economics of Development, AUA; Fall 2016, 2017 (in English) |
| Lectures | Principles of Microeconomics, AUA; Spring 2014–2017 (in English) |
| Lectures | Principles of Macroeconomics, AUA; Spring 2015–2017 (in English) |
| Lectures & tutorials | Intermediate Macroeconomics, AUA; Fall 2016 (in English) |
| Lectures & tutorials | Economics of Sustainable Development, AUA; Spring 2016 (in English) |
| Lectures | Introduction to Economics, AUA; Fall 2015 (in English) |
| Lectures | Calculus for Business and Economics (developed and taught the course), AUA; Spring 2015 (in English) |
| | *Teaching assistance* |
| Tutorials | Einführung in die VWL (Introduction to Economics), KU; Winter 2023/24 (in German) |
| Tutorials | Decision Theory, KU; Summer 2022, 2023 (in English) |
| Tutorials | Empirische Wirtschaftsforschung I (Econometrics), Bayreuth; Summer 2019 (in German) |

**Master's courses**

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| | *Independent teaching* |
| Lectures | Quantitative Methods for Economists, AUA; Spring 2014–2017 (in English) |
| Lectures | Mathematics for Economics and Business, ICARE; Fall 2012–2013 (in English) |
| | *Co-teaching* |
| Seminar | Current Issues in Tax Policy, KU; Winter 2022/23–2026/27 (in English) |
| | *Teaching assistance* |
| Tutorials | Tax Policy, KU; Summer 2022–2026 (in English) |
| Tutorials | Tax Research, KU; Summer 2022–2026 (in English) |

# Teaching Awards and Evaluations

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| | Consistently excellent student evaluations of teaching (available upon request) |
| 2015 | **Faculty Teaching Excellence Award** (with a $1,000 prize), AUA |

# Thesis Supervision and Student Advising

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| 2022–2026 | Master's thesis supervision, KU<br>4 completed master's theses |
| 2015–2018 | Faculty Advisor to the Graduate Student Council, AUA |

# Course Coordination

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| 2022–2026 | **Lecture Series Sustainable Economy**, KU<br>Ringvorlesung Nachhaltige Wirtschaft (undergraduate, in German)<br>Coordinated planning and administration; attended weekly sessions and provided technical and other support for rotating guest lecturers |

# Research

Job-Market Paper

**Bypassing Sanctions: Hide 'N Seek in Tax Havens** download
(with Dominika Langenmayr and Sebastian Vosseler)
Revise and resubmit, *Journal of International Economics*

Do financial sanctions induce targets to move assets beyond the sanctioning country's reach? We combine quarterly BIS data on bilateral bank deposits with U.S. and EU financial sanctions from 1996–2023 and exploit variation in sanction timing across countries. Individual sanctions increase deposits in tax havens: by about 18% after U.S. sanctions and 46% after EU sanctions. Deposits simultaneously fall in sanctioning jurisdictions, especially after EU sanctions. When sanctions are more severe because the U.S. and EU sanction jointly, haven deposits do not increase on average; deposits in other foreign countries fall and domestic deposits rise. Major sanctions likewise restrict foreign deposits more broadly. Combining leaked offshore data with individual-level sanctions, we find that sanctioned individuals rely on existing shell companies, while other residents establish new offshore structures, potentially anticipating further sanctions.

Other Working Papers

**Elections and Offshore Deposits: Evidence from Close Electoral Turnovers**
(with Sebastian Vosseler)

We examine whether electoral turnovers affect offshore bank deposits, considering competing channels involving accountability, enforcement expectations and political uncertainty. The analysis combines quarterly bilateral BIS foreign bank deposit & offshore leaks data, with regression discontinuity and difference-in-differences designs.

**The Education Gambit: Chess, Cognitive Skills, and a Natural Experiment in Armenia**

I investigate whether Armenia's compulsory primary-school chess program affects students' cognitive performance in the school and long-term participation in competitive chess. The analysis combines adjacent-grade difference-in-differences & triple-differences designs using mathematics and language contest data with cohort comparisons and synthetic-control analysis of competitive-chess records.

Work in Progress

**Film Publicity and the Allocation of Biodiversity Contributions**

I study whether film publicity changes the allocation of voluntary contributions to biodiversity information—a public resource whose provision depends on private decisions. Using weekly counts of crowdsourced, species-specific wildlife observations from *iNaturalist* and a seasonal difference-in-differences design, I compare records concerning rabbits and hares with those concerning a fixed group of other animals around the 2018 U.S. release of *Peter Rabbit*.

**Does Rent Control Increase Crime? Evidence from Germany**
(with Seraphin Schwarzbauer)

We investigate whether housing-market regulation has broader social consequences beyond rents, focusing on the effects of Germany's rent regulation for new tenancies (*Mietpreisbremse*) on crime. Using municipality-level police-recorded crime data, we compare designated and non-designated areas before and after the reform, examining outcomes such as burglary, assault, and domestic violence, as well as differences by pre-reform rental exposure and housing conditions.

## Conference and Seminar Presentations

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| 2026 | German Economic Association Annual Conference, Innsbruck; Armenian Economic Association Annual Meetings, Yerevan; International Tax Observatory, Paris School of Economics |
| 2025 | International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF) Annual Conference, Nairobi; Bavarian PhD Workshop in Development Economics, FAU Erlangen-Nürnberg; Armenian Economic Association Annual Meetings, Yerevan |
| 2024 | Public Finance Research Seminar (ifo/LMU), Munich; ZEW Public Finance Conference, Mannheim |
| 2023 | Public Finance Research Seminar (ifo/LMU), Munich; Armenian Economic Association Annual Meetings, Yerevan |

## Doctoral training

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| 2026 | Paris School of Economics<br>Geolocalized Datasets and Applications for Economics |
| 2022–2024 | Bavarian Graduate Program in Economics (BGPE)<br>Advanced Econometrics; Causal Effects in Applied Economics; Machine Learning for Economists; Advanced Macroeconomics; Empirical Labor Economics |
| 2022–2023 | KU doctoral program<br>Research Agenda Management; Theoretical and Empirical Modeling |

## Academic Service

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| 2025 | Discussant, International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF) Annual Conference, Nairobi; Bavarian PhD Workshop in Development Economics, FAU Erlangen-Nürnberg |
| 2024 | Discussant, ZEW Public Finance Conference |
| 2023 | Discussant, Virtual Doctoral Tax Seminar, University of Mannheim |
| 2014–2018 | Served on the AUA Faculty Senate during the lecturer appointment |

## Scholarships and Research Funding

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| 2026 | Erasmus+ Staff Training Mobility Grant for a research stay at the International Tax Observatory, Paris School of Economics |
| 2009 | Luys Scholarship for M.Sc. Economics studies at LSE |
| 1997–2001 | Armenian Government Full Merit Scholarship for B.Sc. studies |

## Other Professional Experience

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| 2012–2014 | **Head of Economic Impact Assessment Unit**<br>Guillotine (a regulatory reform project), Government Staff of the Republic of Armenia<br>Assessed costs of tax legislation; managed a five-person impact assessment team, coordinated its work with 15 reviewers, and trained new team members |
| 2011–2012 | **Private Tutor**, London<br>Mathematics, statistics, and economics |
| 2002–2009 | **Tax Advisor**<br>Prepared income-tax declarations for individuals and sole proprietors and planned tax strategies for small businesses |

## Languages and Software

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| Languages | English, German, Russian (near-native/C2); Armenian (native);<br>French (basic/A2). |
| Software | Stata; R; LaTeX<br>Basic knowledge: Python; MATLAB; ArcGIS |

## References

**Prof. Dr. Dominika Langenmayr**
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**Prof. Dr. Zareh Asatryan**
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